



Community Stakeholder Sensitization and Consultation Process: Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Effective Date: 17 March 2014

1. **PURPOSE:** The purpose of BCP's **Community Stakeholder Sensitization and Consultation Process** is to ensure that community stakeholders for BCP's REDD+ projects are fully and accurately sensitized and consulted, in line with the principles of obtaining Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) from REDD+ project community stakeholders. The process is designed to:
 - a. Achieve regular sensitization of community stakeholders
 - b. Ensure that community stakeholder sensitization is accurate, consistent and appropriate
 - c. Ensure that documentation exists to demonstrate sensitization has taken place in line with external (CCBA, VCS) and internal sensitization requirements.
2. **DELIVERABLES:** It is the responsibility of the **Community Engagement Officer – Sensitization Officer (CEO-SO)** to ensure that BCP's Community Stakeholder Sensitization and Consultation Process takes place:
 - a. The CEO-SO shall work with CET members to develop **Monthly Sensitization Schedules** and to define **Monthly and Yearly Sensitization Targets**, which will be clearly communicated to the CET.
 - i. Monthly sensitization schedules and targets are submitted on the 1st day of every month.
 - ii. Yearly Sensitization Targets are submitted by the 15th of January, annually.
 - b. The CEO-SO is responsible for ensuring that CET members achieve sensitization "deliverables":
 - i. Sensitization meetings must take place in line with FPIC requirements
 - ii. Necessary documentation must be completed and submitted to BCP
 - iii. **Sensitization schedules should achieve sensitization targets**
 - c. **All CET members** are responsible for promoting sensitization in line with this SOP.
 - d. The CEO-SO shall submit a **Monthly Sensitization Report** to the LZRP Project Manager(s):
 - i. The Monthly Sensitization Report will include statistics of the number of meetings held, number of (new) individuals sensitized, and will identify locations of sensitization meetings and highlight any important achievements and/or concerns.
 - ii. Monthly Sensitization Reports are to be submitted to the Project Manager by the last day of every month, outlining sensitization achievements within the previous month.
 1. All sensitization records claimed within Monthly Sensitization Reports must be documented in corresponding Meeting Minutes and Attendance Sheets.
 2. Accompanying Meeting Minutes and Attendance Sheets must be submitted to the Director along with Monthly Sensitization Reports, or more regularly, if possible.
 3. Statistics claimed in Monthly Sensitization Reports (or similar documents) that are not confirmed by supporting documentation (meeting minutes and attendance sheets) shall be considered as "incomplete" and will not be accepted.
 - e. It is the responsibility of the Community Engagement Manager to provide regular oversight of the CEO-SO, and to ensure that BCP's **Community Stakeholder Sensitization and Consultation Process** achieves sensitization targets in line with FPIC.

3. **CONTENT:** The content contained in the **CORE CONTENT Outline** of this SOP MUST be presented at Community Stakeholder Sensitization and Consultation Meetings.
4. **TRAINING:** It is the responsibility of BCP's CEO-SO to ensure that this information is fully and accurately presented to stakeholders at all Community Stakeholder Sensitization and Consultation Meetings.
 - a. The CEO-SO must train members of the CET to effectively achieve sensitization deliverables.
 - b. CET members shall be held individually accountable for achieving sensitization deliverables.
5. **DOCUMENTATION:** The content of Community Stakeholder Sensitization and Consultation Meetings should be fully and accurately documented in formal signed Sensitization **Meeting Minutes**, which shall be kept on record by BCP.
 - a. Meeting Minutes must be **signed** by local leaders and/or meeting participants, confirming their accuracy – Meeting Minutes should fully and truthfully document the content of each meeting.
 - b. Meeting Minutes must be accompanied by **Attendance Sheets**, for each meeting.
 - i. Attendance sheets should contain the NAMES and CONTACT INFORMATION of participants
 - c. It is a key “deliverable” of completing sensitization that Signed Meeting Minutes and a corresponding Attendance Sheet must be submitted—until these are received, BCP cannot “count” sensitization data from the meeting, and the “deliverable” of holding a sensitization meeting will not be considered complete.
 - d. Meeting Minutes must demonstrate that sensitization took place according to this SOP.
6. **DOCUMENTATION:** It is the responsibility of BCP's Sensitization Officer to ensure that BCP receives documentation that every Community Stakeholder Sensitization and Consultation Meetings has taken place, in line with FPIC requirements:
 - a. The BCP Representative responsible for each meeting must document that all content topics have been accurately addressed, as part of the Signed Meeting Minutes that they must submit.
 - i. On the **Sensitization Minutes Template**, an **X** should be placed next to each corresponding sensitization topic, indicating that the topic was fully and accurately addressed.
 - ii. Representatives should NOT mark an X if the topic has not been fully or accurately addressed:
 1. Explanation should be provided as to why a topic was not fully or accurately addressed
 2. A plan should be outlined for ensuring that the topic is later fully and accurately addressed
 - iii. Additional discussions (including questions AND answers) should be clearly, fully and truthfully documented in the Signed Meeting Minutes for each meeting.
 - b. Disciplinary action will be taken against BCP employees who do not truthfully document the content of meetings within Meeting Minutes.
7. **RESPONSIBILITY:** It is a “deliverable” of CET employee contracts that CET members truthfully and accurately represent BCP, and conduct community sensitization and consultation in line with FPIC requirements.
8. **SENSITIZATION EVENTS:** A “Sensitization Event” occurs whenever a BCP member sensitizes a **community stakeholder** fully and in line with this SOP. A sensitization event can include 1 or 100 participants.
 - a. For each Sensitization Event, **1) Meeting Minutes** and **2) Signed Attendance Sheet** MUST be submitted as supporting documents.

OUTLINE OF “CORE CONTENT” – BASIC INFORMATION ABOUT REDD+ (to be presented by BCP Representative(s))

The BCP Representative responsible for each meeting must indicate that each content topic has been discussed, and/or provide explanation as to why a particular topic was not discussed, and outline a plan for ensuring that all core content is communicated.

- . Confirmation of Full and Accurate Discussion of each topic should be marked with an “X” by each corresponding section on the meeting minutes for each meeting.
- . Notes about additional discussions that were held, or problems encountered, should be clearly and fully documented on the Meeting Minutes by the BCP employee responsible for each meeting.

The following content is required to be presented at each BCP Sensitization and Consultation Meeting:

1. DESCRIPTION OF BCP:

- a. BioCarbon Partners (BCP) is a social enterprise – we are a Zambian company committed to achieving positive impacts for local communities, and protecting local forests.
- b. BCP launches REDD+ Projects
- c. The AIMS of BCP are:
 - 1) To protect local forests, by reducing deforestation
 - 2) To improve local livelihoods, by launching community projects designed to reduce poverty and provide alternatives to activities that cause deforestation (such as charcoal production)
 - 3) To work in partnership with local communities to do these things.

2. DESCRIPTION OF REDD:

- a. REDD: Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and forest Degradation (“Avoiding Deforestation”, which causes climate change)
- b. REDD+ Projects are designed to bring lasting positive impacts to local communities, forests and biodiversity

3. EXPLANATION OF THE LINK BETWEEN DEFORESTATION AND CLIMATE CHANGE:

a. DEFORESTATION → EMISSIONS → CLIMATE CHANGE

b. Explanation: Scale of Deforestation in Zambia

- I. Zambia is losing 250,000 – 300,000 hectares of forest per year right now – this is a conservative (low) estimate.
 - 30,000 hectares is the size of about 10 Rufunsa Conservancies, or, if average farm size in the project zone is 3 hectares, then approximately 100,000 farms from the local area.
- II. In 2013, Zambia’s annual amount of deforestation is the highest in Africa – Zambia is losing more trees every year than any other African country!
- III. Zambia’s national average deforestation rate is among the highest in the world
- IV. In the area where the Lower Zambezi REDD+ Project is taking place, in Rufunsa District, BCP calculates that the rate of deforestation is 11 times higher than Zambia’s national average – this place is losing more trees faster than most other places in the world!
- V. Even though it appears that there are many trees in Zambia, many trees are being cut at a very fast rate—so Zambia is losing its forests very quickly

c. Explanation: Negative Effects of Deforestation (Deforestation Causes Emissions of Carbon Dioxide, which is linked to causing Climate Change)

- I. **Earth's atmosphere** contains **Carbon Dioxide (CO₂)** and **Oxygen (O₂)**
- II. Normally, there should be a "balance" between CO₂ and Oxygen (O₂) and in the atmosphere
- III. Plants and animals "work together" to maintain this balance:
 - Animals breathe in oxygen, and breathe out carbon dioxide (this process is called "respiration")
 - Plants "breathe in" CO₂ and breathe out O₂, in an opposite process.
- IV. Large-scale deforestation negatively affects this balance of CO₂ and O₂ in our atmosphere (and this causes climate change) in 2 main ways:
 - If you cut down a tree, that tree no longer removes carbon dioxide from the atmosphere, and it does not release oxygen into the atmosphere. If you cut down many trees, this can contribute to a build-up of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere.
 - After you cut a tree, it releases the carbon that was stored in its "biomass" (body). This carbon joins with oxygen in the atmosphere, to form carbon dioxide. If you burn a tree, the tree emits carbon dioxide in the form of smoke. Even if you don't burn a tree, if you allow a tree to rot or decompose, then over time the carbon stored within is released.
- V. These two ways explain why we say that deforestation causes emissions of carbon dioxide—because cutting trees releases carbon dioxide into the atmosphere, and also prevents those trees from removing carbon dioxide from the atmosphere.
- VI. The emissions caused by deforestation upset (negatively impact) the normal "balance" between oxygen and carbon dioxide in the atmosphere
- VII. Atmospheric imbalance caused by emissions has led to the "Greenhouse Effect":
 - **GREENHOUSE EFFECT:** Emissions have formed a "blanket" in the earth's atmosphere, and this blanket traps the sun's rays within earth's atmosphere. This effect has caused global temperatures to rise, which has severe impacts on global climate.
- VIII. Although this process is often referred to as "**global warming**," it is not correct to assume that this means that the temperature is rising everywhere. It only means that, on average, the overall global temperature is rising. This rise in global temperature has different climactic effects on different places.
 - In some places, "global warming" is causing bad storms, in others, droughts.
- IX. The term **climate change** is used to describe the many environmental and climactic changes that are taking place across the world as a result of this imbalance, caused by emissions.
- X. Deforestation is not the only cause of emissions, which cause this atmospheric imbalance that results in global climate change. Industrial emissions and emissions from the transportation sector also contribute heavily to this imbalance. However, deforestation is still a major cause/contributor of emissions: current estimates are that approximately 15% of global emissions are caused by deforestation, which means that deforestation is about as significant (or more significant) than the global transportation sector (including emissions caused by cars, airplanes, trucks, etc.).

→ AT THIS POINT, PARTICIPANTS SHOULD RECEIVE COPIES OF BCP'S REDD+ INFORMATIONAL COMIC

→ The BCP Representative should remind participants:

- **REDD+ Projects reduce deforestation, to reduce the onset/impacts of global climate change**
- **Global climate change has negative effects on local communities and local forests**
- **REDD+ projects are designed to have positive effects on local communities and local forests**

4. DESCRIPTION OF the LOWER ZAMBEZI REDD+ PROJECT (LZRP):

. The LZRP is taking place on Rufunsa Conservancy – this means that BCP is protecting forest in Rufunsa Conservancy

- Rufunsa Conservancy is the “**Project Area**” for the LZRP – **no deforestation allowed in the Project Area**
- Rufunsa Conservancy is “private property” – the property is legally titled, and the title is recognized by the Government of Zambia (the Office of the President)
- The boundaries of the property were demarcated by the property owner (Sable Transport), local traditional leaders (Headmen and the Chief), and the Government of Zambia. These boundaries are legally recognized by the government.
- The boundaries of the LZRP are the boundaries of Rufunsa Conservancy – BCP is following the property boundaries that are listed in the legally-recognized title.

. The **Project Zone** for the LZRP includes Chilimba, Mweeshangombe, Namanongo and Ndubulula zones:

- In the Project Zone, BCP is working with local communities to reduce the drivers of deforestation—we aim to work in partnership with local communities to launch community projects that improve livelihoods, reduce poverty, and provide alternatives to deforestation
- BCP is NOT telling communities what to do on community land in the Project Zone:
 - o We are not telling communities that they have to stop producing charcoal—we are not forcing.
 - o We are *not* telling communities to stop deforestation on community land – if communities need to clear areas of community forests in the project zone, we will not stop them.
 - o We are working to try and reduce the need that communities might face to clear (deforest) community forests, over time. But unless we sign agreements with local communities to protect areas of community forests, we cannot tell the communities what to do on community land.
 - o We are trying to improve community livelihoods and *reduce* deforestation of community forest
- BCP is only telling communities to stop deforestation in the Project Area of Rufunsa Conservancy, which is a private property not located on community forest.
 - o We have a legal right to protect the boundaries of Rufunsa Conservancy, which are recognized by the Government of Zambia, and documented in the private property title.

. **UPDATES from the LZRP:**

- BCP’s LZRP has achieved “gold level” validation against the Climate, Community and Biodiversity Alliance (CCBA) Standards – this is international recognition that our project is designed to positively impact local communities, wildlife, and the environment!
- BCP’s LZRP is currently undergoing “verification” against the Verified Carbon Standard (VCS).
 - o VCS verification will determine if the project is successful
 - o VCS verification checks that BCP is able to protect the forest within the REDD+ Project Area (Rufunsa Conservancy) – if we cannot show that we are protecting the forest, if there is ongoing encroachment into the property, then the project will not succeed.
 - o VCS verification takes place every year, so we have to ensure we are able to protect the forest long-term (every year)
- BCP has launched over 30 community projects across all 4 community zones (see next page):

- BCP community projects launched in 2012-2013:
 - 22 Village Chicken Projects in all 4 zones (300+ people!)
 - Conservation Farming Training Program (CFTP) in all 4 zones (200+ people!)
 - Sustainable Eco-Charcoal Project in Ndubulula, and we are now working to expand this into a new zone (Namanongo?)
 - Teacher Salary Support Program in Mweeshangombe and Chilimba Zones
 - Environmental Education Program (EEP) to begin in Ndubulula and Namanongo zones in 2014
 - Borehole repair in Ndubulula; Water 282 partnership in Mweeshangombe and Namanongo (2014)
 - Mushroom Production Project (pilot) in Mweeshangombe – to expand
 - Dried Fruit Project (pilot) to begin soon, with the potential to expand
 - Community Livestock Worker Program
 - Solar Extension Agent Program
 - Employment of Community members
- BCP wants to work in partnership to make this project succeed! Even though the LZRP is not taking place on community forest, we want to show local communities that it is possible to benefit from forest protection activities under REDD+! → BCP and communities need to work together to make this project succeed!

5. FPIC REQUIREMENTS FOR REDD+:

- . Participation in REDD+ Projects is voluntary—BCP is not forcing communities to do anything on community land, and communities do not have to join in BCP's project activities if they don't want to
- . REDD+ Projects are “long term”: BCP's Lower Zambezi REDD+ Project is expected to last 30 years
- . BCP does not need or want “title” to any community land to launch a REDD+ Project – when we launch REDD+ projects, we partner with the landowner(s) and local communities to do so.
- . REDD+ is a **pay-for-performance** activity:
 - REDD+ Projects are successful when they can demonstrate that they are protecting areas of forest
 - If BCP cannot protect the REDD+ Project Area forest, the REDD+ project cannot succeed or continue
 - If local communities cooperate to protect forest areas protected by REDD+, they can receive benefits through participating in BCP's REDD+ project activities
 - If local communities do not help to protect local forests protected through REDD+, BCP is not required to provide any benefits – we will need to channel resources from the REDD+ project towards protecting local forests, rather than engaging in local communities, if the communities do not work with us.
 - The Lower Zambezi REDD+ Project is not taking place on community forest; it is taking place on a private area of forest in private property, near to communities
 - BCP wants to partner with local communities to improve local livelihoods and provide them with alternatives, so that we do not have any conflicts—now or in the future—over the private area of forest protected in the project area
- . If the community has any concerns, they have the right to follow the **grievance mechanism**:
 - Start local: report problems to the local BCP Community Mobilizer, then the Community Engagement Manager. If problems continue, you have the right to involve or seek help from an external partner, or to consult a lawyer.
 - BCP will facilitate community access to these resources, to ensure that grievances are resolved.

6. ***Any additional questions or discussions that take place during the meeting should be documented on Signed Meeting Minutes.***